

High Priority

- Ensure no design will harm the turtles.
- Basking platform revision
 - Both of our stakeholders Attia and Hailey have both mentioned that the basking platform doesn't have a sufficient size to properly house both turtles at the same time. While they didn't give us desired dimensions, of an upgrade nor do we have dimensions of the current basking platform, we estimate the platform needs to be 36 x 25 x 15 inches to sufficiently house both turtles. Additionally, the platform will have two levels for each turtle so they have their own space while they bask.
- Textured Grip Surface
 - Hailey noted that the turtles occasionally slip when climbing onto or resting on the basking platform, which can cause stress and potential injury. To address this, we propose adding textured grip surfaces along the ramps and platform floor such as marine silicone. These surfaces could be made from reptile-safe rubber mats or cork sheets, cut to fit the estimated ramp dimensions of 11 x 7 inches for the female and 6 x 5 inches for the male.. The textured material will provide traction without being abrasive to the turtles' shells or skin, ensuring safe access and stability while entering the platform.. Additionally, the grip surfaces will be removable for cleaning and replacement, allowing caretakers to maintain hygiene standards while reducing maintenance burdens. This modification enhances both turtle comfort and safety, while aligning with Hailey's concerns about accessibility and welfare (idea generated with copilot, 11/13/25).
- Ramp Variation (Changed from diet monitoring on 11/13/25)
 - Attia has informed us that the turtles often struggle to get onto the basking platform, so we have come up with a solution to address this issue. The idea is a two level ramp system. The top ramp will be 11x7 inches to account for the female, and the bottom ramp will be 6x5 inches to account for the male.
- Artificial Turf Floor for basking platform
 - Both Attia and Hailey have expressed concerns about the comfort of the basking platform surface, noting that the current hard material does not provide adequate grip or cushioning for the turtles. To address this, we propose lining the basking platform with artificial turf that is non-toxic, water-resistant, and removable for cleaning. The turf will be cut to fit the estimated platform dimensions of 36 x 25 inches and securely fastened to prevent shifting while the turtles climb. This modification will provide a softer, more natural-feeling surface that reduces the risk of abrasions, improves traction, and enhances overall comfort during basking.

Additionally, the removable design ensures caretakers can easily disinfect or replace the turf as needed, maintaining hygiene standards without adding significant maintenance burdens.(idea generated with co-pilot on 11/13/25)